

The Fall of Ouranos

Unknown to Ouranos, Gaia had been harboring a great deal of anger toward him for banishing their children, the Hecatoncheires and the Cyclopes.

“Ouranos’s power has gone to his head,” Gaia thought. “Something needs to be done about it.” She could not defeat Ouranos alone, because he could use his weight to overpower her. Instead, she went to her bravest son for help. This was the Titan named Cronos.

Gaia handed Cronos a sharp sickle.

Cronos agreed to help Gaia conquer Ouranos if he could then rule the universe.

Gaia sharpened a piece of rock and used it to create a jagged-edged sickle, which she took to Cronos. “My son,” she said, “take this sickle and wait here until your father, Ouranos, comes to visit me. Hide nearby, and when his back is turned, strike him!” Cronos, excited to have his father’s power, grabbed it.

As Gaia had asked, Cronos waited until Ouranos appeared. Ouranos did not notice his son lying in wait. When Ouranos turned away, Cronos jumped out at his father and cut him with the sickle.